

Walter Coots

Austin, TX | +1 (512) 965-7567 | walter@waltercoots.com | waltercoots.com | linkedin.com/in/waltercoots

Summary

Senior Product Designer with 20+ years building web products and software, most recently leading design for an enterprise B2B HR SaaS platform through 4x ARR growth and an acquisition. Specializes in complex, data-heavy products: design systems built on Figma variables and tokens, information architecture, and LLM-powered features. Works directly with executive leadership on product strategy and prototypes in code with Claude Code.

Experience

Senior Product Designer, WorkStep

May 2022–Present | Enterprise B2B HR SaaS | Austin, TX (Remote)

- Designed the core product through WorkStep's growth from \$2M to \$8M ARR, as the company landed enterprise customers including PepsiCo, PetSmart, and JB Hunt
- Led a full information architecture overhaul of the platform, simplifying navigation and dashboards and making room for new features to scale.
- Designed and maintained data visualizations and interactive charts for large scale data
- Rebuilt the Figma design system from scratch with variables and design tokens, cutting component bloat by 85% and building to WCAG AA contrast standards
- Designed an LLM-powered AI assistant for insights and notifications, plus LLM-based comment grouping for survey analysis
- Shipped enterprise features including a report builder, broadcast messaging, role-based access control (RBAC), survey translation, and data export
- Prototyped post-acquisition integration work in code using Claude Code

Head of Design, Unilease

July 2021–May 2022 | Commercial Real Estate SaaS | Austin, TX (Remote)

- Led end-to-end product design for early-stage commercial real estate platform, shaping product direction from concept through launch
- Designed MVP experience and marketing site to support go-to-market efforts and investor conversations
- Defined product vision and design standards for the company's core platform

Senior Product Designer, T3 (now Material+)

November 2019–July 2021 | Agency | Austin, TX

- Design lead for large-scale digital initiatives for Fortune 500 clients, guiding UX strategy and execution across multidisciplinary teams

- Mentored and directed other designers while collaborating closely with engineering, PM, and client stakeholders

Lead UX/UI Designer, EverlyWell

March 2018–September 2019 | Healthcare | Austin, TX

- Sole product designer during critical growth phase from Series A to Series B, shaping core product experience and customer journey
- Led prototyping and feature launches across consumer health platform, partnering with product, marketing, and executive leadership
- Contributed to sales enablement and investor materials through high-fidelity prototypes and marketing initiatives
- Redesigned and A/B tested the PDP yielding a 25% increase in sales

Lead Designer, Insitome

August 2017–March 2018 | Genetics / Entertainment | Austin, TX

- Led product design for genomics entertainment startup across web and iOS platforms
- Served as UX and UI gatekeeper, guiding product direction and maintaining consistency across releases
- Designed and implemented a platform-agnostic design system to unify experience across devices
- Concepted and validated new product features through wireframes and prototypes

Senior Designer, Foxtrot

June 2015–August 2017 | Agency | Austin, TX

- Led UX and visual strategy for clients across industries, presenting concepts and facilitating stakeholder alignment
- Mentored designers and improved internal workflows through collaboration and hiring involvement
- Delivered responsive web experiences in close partnership with developers and PMs

Lead Designer, The Daily Dot

March 2013–May 2015 | Media | Austin, TX

- Led UX and visual evolution of consumer media platform and internal publishing tools
- Built style guides and UI systems to support scalable editorial and product growth
- Partnered with sales team to concept and pitch native advertising solutions, bridging design and revenue strategy

Senior Interaction Designer, Intuit

June 2009–February 2013 | Finance | Plano, TX

- Designed workflows and interaction systems across desktop, web, and mobile financial products

- Planned and conducted user research to inform product decisions and reduce usability friction
- Facilitated workshops and presented concepts to senior leadership, advocating for user-centered strategy at scale

Web Designer, ImageVisible

September 2006–June 2008 | Agency | Dallas, TX

- Designed and developed websites and digital campaigns for national and regional clients including Southwest Airlines and Denny's
- Managed client communication, scope, alignment, and frontend collaboration across multidisciplinary teams

Web Designer, KnightWorks

May 2005–August 2006 | Agency | Dallas, TX

- Designed and developed interactive web experiences and e-learning applications
- Collaborated on multimedia production including video shoots and post-production editing

Web Designer, Thinking Inc

August 1999–October 2000 | Agency | Dallas, TX

- Designed, developed, and maintained client websites, gaining early professional experience in digital design and development
- Contributed to print collateral and brand materials for small business clients

Tools

Graphics & Prototyping

Figma, Sketch, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe InDesign, Adobe Lightroom

Collaboration, Ideation, AI

FigJam, Linear, Jira, Confluence, Eagle, Granola, Miro, Claude, Claude Code, ChatGPT, Cursor, Figma Make

Technical

HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Vue, Git, GSAP

Motion, Audio & Video

Adobe After Effects, Adobe Premiere Pro, Adobe Audition, BodyMovin, Lottie, Adobe Animate, Adobe Media Encoder

Skills

Core Product Capabilities

Product Strategy, Product Design, User Experience Design, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Design Systems and Scalability, User Research and Testing, Prototyping and

Validation

Leadership and Collaboration

Design Leadership, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Roadmapping, Design Operations, Mentorship and Critique, Workshop Facilitation

Visual and Interaction Craft

UI and Visual Design, Microinteractions, Motion Graphics, Typography and Visual Hierarchy

Education

BFA, Visual Communication, Texas A&M University-Commerce (Dallas)

2006–2009

UX Bootcamp, Cooper

October 2016